

Excel for Accounting and Inventory Reporting

(Automate calculations and reduce errors in daily reporting)

Overview

This course uses an artifact sequence approach in which participants build a complete, formula-driven accounting and inventory workbook across five topic blocks. At the start of the session, participants import a live dataset from the web and rename it as a named Table. Each topic block then builds on that Table: extending it with calculated columns, automating calculations, cross-referencing records, summarizing results with formula-driven summaries and a chart, and validating the completed workbook before distribution.

Objectives

Upon completion of the course, participants will be able to build a formula-driven, error-resistant Excel workbook for accounting and inventory reporting.

Specifically, participants will be able to:

- organize raw data into structured Excel Tables for accurate, scalable formulas
- automate recurring calculations using conditional and lookup functions
- cross-reference records across tables to reduce manual checking
- summarize and present data using formula-driven summaries, conditional formatting, and charts
- validate and protect a completed workbook before distribution

Who Should Participate

- Assistant to Managerial-level staff who prepare or review accounting and inventory reports.
- Employees who use Excel daily for reporting and want to work more efficiently.
- Staff who rely on manual re-typing, copy-paste, or unstructured ranges for reporting.
- Anyone with basic Excel familiarity who needs reliable, formula-driven reporting skills.

Key Topics

- I. Working with the Imported Excel Table
 - a. Applying Table styles and print-ready layout
 - b. Adding calculated columns to the Table
 - c. Freezing panes and adjusting column widths
 - d. Adding a Total Row to summarize key columns
- II. Automating Everyday Calculations
 - a. Typing SUM, AVERAGE, COUNT, and COUNTA formulas
 - b. Using IF to flag stock and payment status
 - c. Using SUMIFS and COUNTIFS for conditional sums
 - d. Wrapping formulas in IFERROR for clean outputs
- III. Cross-Referencing Data Across Tables
 - a. Matching records across tables using XLOOKUP
 - b. Convert query-connected tables to ranges
 - c. Dropdown lists via Data → Data Validation
 - d. Sorting and filtering via Sort and AutoFilter
- IV. Summarizing and Presenting Data
 - a. Building a SUMIFS-driven summary sheet
 - b. Applying conditional formatting for exceptions
 - c. Inserting a chart via Insert → Charts
 - d. Structuring a management-ready report layout
- V. Validating and Finalizing the Workbook
 - a. Testing formulas against a revised dataset
 - b. Auditing via Formulas → Formula Auditing tools
 - c. Resolving #N/A, #REF!, and #DIV/0! error states
 - d. Protecting the sheet via Review → Protect Sheet

Trainer Verification

Session Preparation Note: Before Topic I begins, guide participants through importing the dataset via Data → Get Data → From Web. The imported data arrives as a query-connected Table. Participants then name the Table before Topic I starts. These steps are preparation, not course skills, and should be covered in the PowerPoint as a pre-session setup slide.

- I. Working with the Imported Excel Table
 - a. Table styles applied and layout is print-ready
 - b. Calculated columns return correct values in each row
 - c. Panes are frozen and column widths are readable
- II. Automating Everyday Calculations
 - a. SUM, AVERAGE, COUNT, and COUNTA return correct values
 - b. IF flags correct rows based on defined threshold or status
 - c. SUMIFS and COUNTIFS return accurate conditional totals
- III. Cross-Referencing Data Across Tables
 - a. XLOOKUP retrieves correct values across tables
 - b. Query table converted to range before validation is applied
 - c. Dropdown list pulls from correct named range source
- IV. Summarizing and Presenting Data
 - a. Summary sheet SUMIFS totals match source table values
 - b. Conditional formatting highlights correct exception rows
 - c. Chart reflects summary data and updates when data changes
- V. Validating and Finalizing the Workbook
 - a. All formulas recalculate correctly on a revised dataset
 - b. Formula Auditing confirms correct precedent references
 - c. Refresh all queries before applying sheet protection